

GCL Tech

Pivot to Multi-Product New Energy Materials - LFP as Growth Engine

GCL Tech announced in mid-May 2026 a shift from being a granular silicon pure play to a global, multi-product new energy materials platform, with LFP cathodes (via its lower-capex, more environmentally friendly physical iron oxide red method) as the next growth engine and silicon-carbon anodes as a second growth curve, alongside plans to expand overseas through capital partnerships and new operating entities. Management emphasized process-driven cost advantages (unit capex ~Rmb8.5k/ton with potential to reach ~Rmb7k/ton) and a focus on higher energy-density 4th/4.5th-gen moving toward 5th-gen products (already in customer testing), arguing high-end supply is tighter and offers better earnings visibility than oversupplied low-end LFP. Capacity is scaling through an administered 150k tpa (ton p.a.) facility (potentially injectable into the listed entity) and a Sichuan 200k tpa project nearing operation, with a further 400k tpa expansion possible. GCL Tech also remains constructive on silicon-carbon anodes given their energy-density uplift versus graphite, and is expanding a pilot line (>1k tpa). We maintain our OW rating on cost leadership and potential market share gains.

Event Summary: Strategic transformation into GCL Tech announced in mid-May 2026 ([link](#)) that it aims to achieve a leap-forward transformation from a “granular silicon single-product champion” to a “globalized multi-product new energy materials platform”. GCL Tech will position the physical iron oxide red method **Lithium Iron Phosphate (LFP)** as a core growth engine and **Silicon-Carbon Anode** as another growth curve with core advantages. Meanwhile, GCL Tech will extend its integrated industrial chain with differentiated advantage to overseas markets through industrial capital cooperation and the establishment of overseas operating entities.

Management has positioned the LFP business as the next growth driver:

- **Technological advantage:** Mgmt highlighted that they are applying the physical iron oxide red method to produce LFP cathodes, which is a simpler and more environmentally friendly process. GCL Tech has made lots of improvements to this process and they are able to produce high energy-density products. Meanwhile, unit capex is significantly lower than other processes. GCL Tech’s current unit capex is Rmb8.5k per ton, and mgmt guided that they see potential to lower this to Rmb7k per ton. Mgmt is targeting to produce high-end LFP cathodes, namely 4th/4.5th-gen moving toward 5th-gen, as higher energy-density products remain comparatively tight, offering better earnings visibility. Its 5th-gen cathodes have already been sent for customer testing, though the verification process typically takes 6-12 months.
- **Capacity expansion:** GCL Tech’s parent group launched a 120k ton production capacity in end-2022, while GCL Tech has been administrating this production facility since 2025, with the current capacity expanded slightly to 150k ton per year. Mgmt commented that potentially the parent group may inject this asset into the listing entity (GCL Tech), but they have not put out a detailed plan yet. In 2H25, GCL Tech started to expand its own LFP cathode production capacity (200k ton per year) in Sichuan, which is expected to be

Overweight

3800.HK, 3800 HK
Price (30 Jul 26):HK\$0.62
Price Target (Jun-27):HK\$1.10

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operational in the next 2-3 months. Mgmt highlighted that the total CAPEX for this project may be Rmb1.7-1.8bn, while GCL Tech will only contribute 30% (roughly Rmb500mn), and the rest will be from local industrial funds. Going forward, GCL Tech may further expand another 400k ton/year LFP cathode production capacity.

- **Competitive landscape:** Mgmt saw that low-end products (low energy-density) are oversupplied, while high energy-density products remain relatively tight. Therefore, they are targeting the high-end market. They named two major competitors, Hunan Yuneng and Fulin Precision. Commercially, mgmt indicated current output is still profitable, citing ASP at Rmb60k+/ton and unit profit at Rmb2–3k/ton, with pricing slightly below peers but supported by process advantages. Customer concentration is notable: ~50% of total production volume is sold to CATL, with the remainder mainly to Hithium and Ganfeng, and GCL Tech aims to diversify toward additional cell makers (e.g., Gotion/LG/BYD).
- **Mgmt remains convinced on silicon-carbon anodes:** GCL Tech is expanding its experimental silicon-carbon anode production line (with capacity over 1000ton/year). Mgmt sees the merits of this technology, as silicon-carbon anodes have a higher unit capacity than mainstream graphite anodes and can significantly increase a battery's energy density.
- **Mgmt sees delays in policy intervention in solar anti-involution:** Without further intervention from regulatory authorities, polysilicon prices have continued to decline, while polysilicon inventory levels have continued to increase. Going forward, mgmt will wait and see if there is any further guidance from the NDRC (National Development and Reform Committee) and if the Pricing Bureau enforces the Price Law rigorously. Indeed, China has released the mandatory national standards for the PV industry on energy consumption and efficiency. However, this may take out $\frac{1}{3}$ (close to 1mn ton/year polysilicon production capacity) of total industry production capacity, resulting in >2mn ton/year production capacity, still ahead of the polysilicon demand (close to 1.5mn ton/year). Going forward, any further policies to boost the demand outlook may help with polysilicon producers' profitability.
- **Action and recommendation:** We maintain an OW rating on GCL Tech. GCL Tech is a cost leader among polysilicon producers and focuses on FBR (fluidized bed reactor) technology. We believe GCL Tech will benefit from the technology disruption of FBR through (1) lower cash costs and (2) rising penetration of FBR, which may lead to rising market share. LPF cathode development is a new venture for GCL Tech, which we have not factored in the earnings contribution. We see a potential option value of HK\$0.15 should it materialize - for further details see our [sector note](#) published today.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

GCL Tech (*Overweight; Price Target: HK\$1.10*)

Investment Thesis

GCL Tech is a cost leader among polysilicon producers and focuses on FBR (fluidized bed reactor) technology. We believe GCL Tech will benefit from the technology disruption of FBR through (1) lower cash costs and (2) rising penetration of FBR, which may lead to rising market share. Meanwhile, we expect the polysilicon cycle to normalize into FY28, benefitting GCL Tech. We have an OW rating on GCL Tech.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 PT of HK\$1.1 is based on a 12-month forward target P/BV of 0.75x. Our target multiple is below the historical average of 1.1x. We believe this valuation is justified, as we expect the polysilicon cycle to normalize into FY28.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

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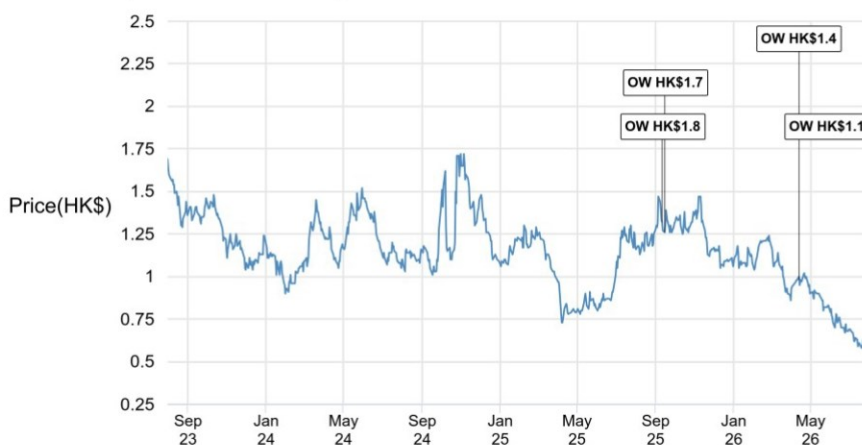
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GCL Tech (3800.HK, 3800 HK) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
12-Sep-25	OW	1.32	1.8
16-Sep-25	OW	1.26	1.7
13-Apr-26	OW	0.98	1.4

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jun 07, 2011. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.
Break in coverage Feb 01, 2021 - Sep 12, 2025.

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